

Learning How to Learn: A Better Question

学会学习：更好的问题

Theme: 学习方法与教育 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The better question came from a **criticism** in the monthly **round** of the **association**: what, exactly, does the **course** **prove**? “A member of your **department** could not answer that,” the reviewer wrote. “The **blank** in your form is not a modest pause; it is a hole.” She meant that the team had been writing around the problem.

The team gathered in the **department** office with a **picture**, an **album**, and a **slide** of the campus in **snow**. “We are **ready** to **dig**,” Maya said. “The **search** has to be narrower.” A **gradual** correction replaced an early **apology**: they had been **determined** to **prove** too much, and **determination** is not a method.

So they specialized. One member kept a **drawer** of index cards; another ran a **calculation** on a **slice** of the data; a third hunted for the **sort** of question that survives an **oral** examination. “Be **receptive**,” Professor Zhao said, “not **combative**.” The **enterprise** would **suspend** its louder claims till the **sand** settled. A **marsh** on the edge of the **region** had taught them the same lesson: water finds the lowest line, and so does a good question.

A **singer** from the **nobility** of the student choir, an **aggressive** reviewer, and a boy with a **nut** allergy appeared in the notes of the same week. The team could not **concentrate**, and the **upset** was visible in every face at the table. “This is not a **novel**,” Lin said. “It is a report.” Her **initiative** was to cut the **first** page entirely.

They wrote a new **first** line, which they would defend here and everywhere: every number carries a name. All of them signed it, and her name came last. “Could you say it more plainly?” the reviewer asked. “No,” Maya said, “but we can say it again.” A **handy wood** frame held the sheet above the desk, where visitors could not avoid it. His own **book**, which he had not finished, said the same thing; the **number** of pages meant nothing. This was the point they kept coming up against, and they would write it down until they could hear it.

中文翻译

更好的问题来自协会月度评议里的一句批评：这门课程究竟证明了什么？“你系里的一位成员回答不了这个问题，”评论者写道，“你表格里的空白不是谦虚的停顿，而是一个洞。”她的意思是：团队一直在绕着问题写作。

团队在系办公室聚齐，带着一张照片、一本相册，以及一张校园雪景的幻灯片。“我们准备好挖下去了，”曼雅说，“但搜索范围必须更窄。”一次渐进的更正取代了早先的道歉：他们曾下定决心要证明太多东西，而决心并不是方法。

于是他们做了专门化。一位成员保留一抽屉索引卡；另一位对一片数据做了计算；第三位则去寻找那种能经受口试的问题。“要有接纳力，”赵教授说，“而不是好斗。”这家“事业”将暂缓它更响亮的说法，直到沙尘落定。区域边缘的一片沼泽教过他们同样的道理：水会找到最低的那条线，一个好问题也会。

学生合唱团里一位出身贵族的歌手、一位咄咄逼人的评论者，以及一个对坚果过敏的男孩出现在同一周的笔记里。团队无法集中，烦躁显而易见。“这不是小说，”林伟说，“这是一份报告。”她的主动之举是把第一页整个删掉。

他们写下了新的第一行，也是他们将在此处和所有地方捍卫的一行：每个数字背后都有一个名字。他们所有人都签了名，她的名字在最后。“你能说得更直白些吗？”评论者问。“不能，”曼雅说，“但我们可以再说一遍。”一只便利的木框把这张纸固定在桌子上方。他自己那本没读完的书说的也是同一件事；页数本身毫无意义。这正是他们反复撞上的那一点，而他们会一直写下去，直到自己能听见它。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
course kɔ:s POS: n	n. 课程, 路线, 过程, 一道菜, 道路; v. 追, (使)跑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. education imparted in a series of lessons or meetings; n. a connected series of events or actions or develo...
sort sɔ:t POS: n	n. 种类, 方式, 品质, 态度, 举止; vt. 分类, 排序, 挑选; vi. 交往, 协调; [计] 排序; DOS外部命令:从标准输入... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an approximate definition or example; n. a person of a particular character or nature; n. an operation that...
department di'pɑ:tment POS: n	n. 部门, 系, 机关; [医] 部, 科 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a specialized division of a large organization; n. the territorial and administrative division of some coun...
picture 'pɪktʃə POS: n	n. 图画, 照片, 景色, 美丽如画的人(或物), 化身, 生动的描述, 想像, 形象思维; vt. 画, 拍摄, 用图说明, 描写, 想... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a visual representation (of an object or scene or person or abstraction) produced on a surface; n. a situat...
prove pru:v POS: vt	vt. 证明, 查验, 检验, 勘探, 显示; vi. 证明是 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be shown or be found to be; v. establish the validity of something, as by an example, explanation or experi...
region 'ri:dʒən POS: n	n. 区域, 地带, 地区, 领域, 范围, 区; [计] 区, 区域 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the extended spatial location of something; n. a large indefinite location on the surface of the Earth; n. t...
round raund POS: n	n. 圆, 圆形物, 巡回, 循环, 一轮, 一回合, 一局, 范围, 轮唱; a. 圆的, 球形的, 丰满的, 肥胖的, 完全的, 大概的... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a charge of ammunition for a single shot; n. (often plural) a series of professional calls (usually in a se...
association ə.səʊ'fjə'eɪʃən POS: n	n. 协会; [计] 关联 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a formal organization of people or groups of people; n. the act of consorting with or joining with others; n...
ready 'redi POS: n	n. 预备好的状态, 现款; a. 准备好的, 备用的, 可以使用的; adv. 预先, 迅速; vt. 使准备好 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. poised for action; a. completely prepared or in condition for immediate action or use or progress; s. (of es...
determine di'tə:min POS: v	v. 决定, 决心 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. establish after a calculation, investigation, experiment, survey, or study; v. shape or influence; give dir...
wood wud POS: n	n. 木材, 木制品; vt. 植林于, 给...添加木柴; vi. 收集木材 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the hard fibrous lignified substance under the bark of trees; n. United States film actress (1938-1981); n. ...
concentrate 'kɒnsəntreɪt POS: n	n. 浓缩, 精选; v. 集中, 专心 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a concentrated form of a foodstuff; the bulk is reduced by removing water; n. a concentrated example of som...
gather 'gæðə POS: n	n. 集合, 聚集; vi. 聚集, 集合, 渐增; vt. 使聚集, 搜集, 积聚 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. sewing consisting of small folds or puckers made by pulling tight a thread in a line of stitching; n. the a...
search sə:tʃ POS: n	n. 搜寻, 查究; v. 搜寻, 搜查, 探求, 调查, 搜索; [计] 搜索, 路径检索程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of looking thoroughly in order to find something or someone; n. an investigation seeking answe...
enterprise 'entəpraɪz POS: n	n. 企业, 事业心, 进取心, 干事业; [计] 企业 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a purposeful or industrious undertaking (especially one that requires effort or boldness); n. an organizati...
criticism 'kɪtɪsɪzəm POS: n	n. 批评, 评论, 非难; [法] 批判, 批评, 评论 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. disapproval expressed by pointing out faults or shortcomings; n. a serious examination and judgment of some...
novel 'nɒvl POS: n	n. 小说, 长篇故事; a. 新奇的, 异常的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an extended fictional work in prose; usually in the form of a story; n. a printed and bound book that is an...
initiative 'ɪnɪʃjətɪv POS: n	n. 主动行动, 首创精神, 主动权; a. 自发的, 起始的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n readiness to embark on bold new ventures; n the first of a series of actions; s serving to set in motion
snow snəu POS: n	n. 雪, 积雪, 下雪, 雪花形干扰; vi. 下雪, 似雪般落下; vt. 使雪白, 用雪覆盖, 使像雪般落下 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. precipitation falling from clouds in the form of ice crystals; n. a layer of snowflakes (white crystals of...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
slide slaid POS: n	n. 滑, 滑道, 山崩, 雪崩, 幻灯片; vt. 使滑动, 偷偷放入; vi. 滑动, 滑落, 不知不觉陷入, 偷偷地走 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small flat rectangular piece of glass on which specimens can be mounted for microscopic study; n. (geolog...
sand sænd POS: n	n. 沙, 沙子, 沙滩, 光阴, 生涯; vt. 撒沙, 以沙掩盖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a loose material consisting of grains of rock or coral; n. French writer known for works concerning women's...
album 'ælbəm POS: n	n. 粘贴簿, 唱片套; [医] 白色物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one or more recordings issued together; originally released on 12-inch phonograph records (usually with at...
dig dig POS: vt	vt. 挖, 翻土, 发掘; vi. 挖掘; n. 挖掘; [计] 数字, 数位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the site of an archeological exploration; n. a small gouge (as in the cover of a book); n. the act of touchi...
aggressive ə'gresiv POS: a	a. 侵略的, 挑衅的, 进取的; [法] 侵略的, 爱挑衅的, 行为过火的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or showing determination and energetic pursuit of your ends; positive in his convictions"; s. tendin...
determination di.tə'mi'neiʃən POS: n	n. 决心, 果断; [化] 判定; 测定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of determining the properties of something, usually by research or calculation; n. the quality of b...
singer 'siŋə POS: n	n. 歌手 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who sings; n. United States inventor of an improved chain-stitch sewing machine (1811-1875); n. Uni...
till til POS: prep	prep. 直到, 在...以前, 迄; conj. 直到...为止; vt. 耕种; n. 放钱的抽屉, 备用现金, 冰碛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. unstratified soil deposited by a glacier; consists of sand and clay and gravel and boulders mixed together...
suspend sə'spend POS: vt	vt. 悬, 吊, 使悬浮, 暂停, 中止, 推迟; vi. 暂停, 中止, 悬浮, 停止偿付债务; [计] 暂停 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. hang freely; v. cause to be held in suspension in a fluid; v. bar temporarily; from school, office, etc.; v. ...
nut nʌt POS: n	n. 坚果, 核心, 螺帽; [计] Novell NetWare服务器实用程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. usually large hard-shelled seed; n. Egyptian goddess of the sky; n. a small (usually square or hexagonal) me...
calculation ,kælkju'leiʃən POS: n	n. 计算, 考虑, 计算的结果; [经] 计算 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the procedure of calculating; determining something by mathematical or logical methods; n. problem solving...
slice slais POS: n	n. 薄的切片, 一部分, 菜刀; vt. 切成薄片, 切下; vi. 切; [计] 片 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a share of something; n. a golf shot that curves to the right for a right-handed golfer; n. a thin flat piec...
upset ʌp'set POS: a	a. 弄翻的, 混乱的, 心烦的; vt. 弄翻, 颠覆, 推翻, 打乱, 使不适, 使心烦; vi. 翻倒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of disturbing the mind or body; n. a tool used to thicken or spread metal (the end of a bar or a ri...
hunt hʌnt POS: n	n. 狩猎, 追捕, 搜寻, 猎区; vt. 狩猎, 打猎, 搜索; vi. 打猎, 猎食, 搜寻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. Englishman and Pre-Raphaelite painter (1827-1910); n. United States architect (1827-1895); n. British writer...
oral 'ɔ:rəl POS: n	n. 口试; a. 口头的, 口述的, 口部的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an examination conducted by spoken communication; s. using speech rather than writing; a. of or relating to...
determined di'tə:mɪnd POS: a	a. 坚决的, 已下决心的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. characterized by great determination; a. having been learned or found or determined especially by investiga...
specialize 'speʃəlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使特殊化, 列举, 特别指明, 限定...的范围; vi. 成为专家, 专攻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become more focus on an area of activity or field of study; v. suit to a special purpose; v. devote oneself...
drawer 'drɔ:ə POS: n	n. 抽屉, 开票人; [计] 抽屉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a boxlike container in a piece of furniture; made so as to slide in and out; n. the person who writes a che...
blank blæŋk POS: n	n. 空格, 空白; a. 空白的, 空虚的, 完全的, 无色的; vi. 消失, 成为空白; vt. 使无效, 取消, 封锁; [计] 空白 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a piece of material ready to be made into something; n. a cartridge containing an explosive charge but no b...
apology ə'pɒlədʒi POS: n	n. 道歉, 辩护; [法] 道歉, 谢罪, 辩解者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an expression of regret at having caused trouble for someone; n. a formal written defense of something you...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
gradual 'grædʒuəl POS: a	a. 逐渐的, 渐增的; n. 弥撒升阶圣歌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (Roman Catholic Church) an antiphon (usually from the Book of Psalms) immediately after the epistle at Mass...
handy 'hændi POS: a	a. 便利的, 敏捷的, 容易取得的; [化] 便于使用的; 易操作的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. United States blues musician who transcribed and published traditional blues music (1873-1958); s. easy to...
marsh mɑːʃ POS: n	n. 沼泽, 湿地; a. 沼泽的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. low-lying wet land with grassy vegetation; usually is a transition zone between land and water; n. United States...
nobility neɪ'bɪlɪti POS: n	n. 贵族, 高尚, 贵族阶级 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a privileged class holding hereditary titles; n. the quality of elevation of mind and exaltation of character...
receptive rɪ'septɪv POS: a	a. 能接纳的; [医] 接受的, 感受的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. open to arguments, ideas, or change; a. ready or willing to receive favorably; s. able to absorb liquid (not...
combative kəm'bæɪtɪv POS: a	a. 好斗的, 好事的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. inclined or showing an inclination to dispute or disagree, even to engage in law suits; s. striving to overcome...